that share Tibet's culture and way of life may have been difficult for Zhou to understand.

These exchanges just go to show that it is not India which is a highly suspicious country but China.

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During my second tenure in China, from 1983 to 1986, relations between the two countries had already taken a positive turn after the years of hostility and chill following the 1962 war. There were high-level visits exchanged, a regular dialogue on the boundary issue and an expansion of trade and economic relations. In 1984, the first-ever visit to India by a high-level delegation from the Chinese Academy of Social Sciences took place. It was led by its then President Ma Hong, a most distinguished economist credited with the introduction of market-oriented reforms in China. His delegation was in India for nearly two weeks visiting several cities. He also made a pilgrimage to Bodh Gaya. I had invited him and some senior members of his delegation to dinner on his return and sought to learn of his impressions of India. While he praised India's development and gave high marks for its economic self-reliance, he could not resist remarking that, on the surface, India appeared chaotic and disorderly. He and his colleagues were puzzled, he said, how the country was still functional. He narrated an incident that occurred on the delegation's car ride from Patna to Bodh Gaya. Their car had to stop as there was an angry demonstration blocking the road. The police in the patrol car accompanying the delegation begged and cajoled the demonstrators to give way to their vehicles and they grudgingly agreed because there was a foreign delegation travelling. The demonstrators were not at all afraid of the police. This, Ma Hong said, was unthinkable in China. The authority of the state was indispensable to political stability and he wondered whether this was not a weakness in India.

A more positive reflection from Ma Hong was about the strength of Indian culture. Despite the fact that India, unlike China, had been open to the world, its classical music maintained deep roots and its women still favoured the elegant saree. With the recent opening up of China, there had